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PDF GUIDE · WARM-UP PROTOCOL

A WARM-UP THAT WORKS.

How to get ready for runs, strength, stations and race day. Set sequences, set doses, set timings. No making it up on the spot.

CONTENTS

01	Warming up isn't wasted time.
02	One warm-up for every session.
03	Your run starts before the start.
04	Heavy loads need a ramp-up.
05	Stations need their own prep.
06	Warm up to your start time.
07	Ten minutes that pay you back.
08	Every exercise in one place.
09	Print it. Stick it up.

01 · THE PRINCIPLE

WARMING UP ISN'T WASTED TIME.

Your warm-up decides how good the first twenty minutes of your session are. On race day, it decides whether you run the first kilometre or your stiff calves do.

We see it every week. Someone comes straight from the office, does two leg swings and goes right into intervals. The first two reps feel stiff, heart rate spikes, pace is off, and the rest of the session is spent playing catch-up. Not because of fitness. Because the body wasn't ready.

A good warm-up raises muscle temperature, takes your joints through the range you'll actually need, switches on the muscles that have to do the work, and primes your nervous system for speed and force. It also gives you five minutes to switch your head from work mode to training mode. That counts too.

RAMP: FOUR STEPS, ONE LOGIC

Every warm-up in this guide follows the same principle. It's called RAMP and it moves from general to specific.

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS	EXAMPLES	TIME
R · Raise	Get heart rate, temperature and blood flow up	Easy jog, bike, row, SkiErg, skipping rope	3–5 min
A · Activate	Switch on the muscles that carry the work: glutes, trunk, upper back	Glute bridge, dead bug, band pull-apart, lateral band walk	2–4 min
M · Mobilise	Move joints through the range the session demands	World's greatest stretch, leg swings, wall ankle mobs, inchworm	3–4 min
P · Potentiate	Bring speed and power up to session level	Running drills, strides, pogos, ramp-up sets, light station work	3–6 min

In practice, activate and mobilise blend together. Mix them in one block if you like. What doesn't change: **start easy and general, finish fast and specific.** The last part of your warm-up should look like the first minute of the session, just shorter and lighter.

HOW LONG

12–15	5–6	35–45
MIN STANDARD	MIN EXPRESS	MIN RACE DAY

For a normal session, 12–15 minutes is plenty. The harder the session, the longer and more specific the final part. An easy run needs less, 400 m repeats need more. Early morning, cold weather or a full day at a desk? Add 3–5 minutes.

HOW TO TELL YOU'RE READY

- [ ] You're warm and lightly sweating, even in a cold gym.
- [ ] You're breathing faster but can still talk in full sentences.
- [ ] Ankles, hips and shoulders move freely, nothing feels sticky or blocked.
- [ ] Your last stride or ramp-up set felt quick and light, not heavy.
- [ ] Your head is in the session. You know what's coming and what your pace or load is.

THE MOST COMMON MISTAKES

STATIC STRETCHING FIRST

Long static holds (30–60 s and more) right before hard work can temporarily blunt force and springiness. Before training, stretch dynamically, on the move. Save static holds for the cool-down or a separate mobility session.

THE WARM-UP BECOMES THE WORKOUT

Burpees to failure and a brisk 2 km "to get warm" is not a warm-up. You burn the energy you need for the main set. Keep it easy, with only the final step short and sharp. Never out of breath.

SKIPPING IT

"I'll warm up on the first rep." Sure, at the cost of a worse first rep and a higher chance of tweaking something. Short on time? Do the express version. Zero is not an option.

LONG GAP AFTER WARMING UP

You warm up, then chat by the rack for 15 minutes and walk into your first set stiff. The effect fades fast. Keep the gap between warm-up and session under 5 minutes. On race day, stay warm (chapter 06).

THE RULE

Same warm-up, same order, every time. Once it's automatic, you don't think, you don't skip, and on race day you'll run through it even with nerves. Repetition builds routine, routine builds calm.

02 · UNIVERSAL WARM-UP

ONE WARM-UP FOR EVERY SESSION.

The core STR2G sequence, 12–15 minutes. Works before running, strength and HYROX sessions. The specific chapters that follow simply build on it.

Learn this sequence by heart. Do it the same way, in the same order, every time. After two weeks you'll run through it without thinking. And you'll know exactly how your body feels that day.

BLOCK 1 · RAISE (4 MIN)

EASY CARDIO 3–4 MIN · RPE 3–4	Jog, bike, row or SkiErg. Conversational pace. Pick it up slightly in the last minute. **Watch out:** this is not training. If you're breathing hard after four minutes, you went too fast.
JUMPING JACKS 30 S	Quick, light, on the balls of your feet. Wakes up calves and shoulders. **Watch out:** land softly, not on your heels.

BLOCK 2 · MOBILISE (4–5 MIN)

WORLD'S GREATEST STRETCH 3 / SIDE	Lunge, elbow to the inside of the front ankle, rotate and reach to the ceiling. Opens hips, thoracic spine and hamstrings in one go. **Watch out:** keep the back knee up and rotate from the ribcage, not the lower back.
LEG SWINGS 10 FRONT-BACK + 10 SIDE / LEG	Hold a wall or rig, swing loosely and build range gradually. **Watch out:** torso stays still, only the leg moves.
WALL ANKLE MOBS 8 / SIDE	Drive the knee over the toes towards the wall, heel stays down. Key for running, lunges and wall balls. **Watch out:** knee tracks over the second toe, doesn't cave in.
INCHWORM 5 REPS	Fold forward, walk the hands out to a plank, short push-up or just hold, walk the feet in to the hands. **Watch out:** legs as straight as comfortable, don't force-lock the knees.

BLOCK 3 · ACTIVATE (3 MIN)

GLUTE BRIDGE
10 REPS · 2 S HOLD

Switches on the glutes that drive the sled, lunges and your running push-off. **Watch out:** drive through the heels, don't arch the lower back at the top.

DEAD BUG
6 / SIDE

Lower back glued to the floor, slowly extend opposite arm and leg. **Watch out:** if your back lifts, shorten the range.

BAND PULL-APART
15 REPS

Shoulder blades back and down, band to the chest. Gets the shoulders ready for SkiErg, row, sled pull and wall balls. **Watch out:** don't shrug.

BLOCK 4 · POTENTIATE (2–3 MIN)

POGO JUMPS
2 × 15 S

Small, fast hops from the ankles, knees almost straight. Tunes calves and Achilles for the push-off. **Watch out:** short ground contact. Bounce off springs, don't jump out of a squat.

SQUAT JUMP OR BROAD JUMP
2 × 3

Explode up or forward, land soft, reset, go again. **Watch out:** quality over quantity. Every jump at about 80%.

Done. Now add the session-specific part (chapters 03–05), or go straight into your first light set.

EXPRESS VERSION (5–6 MIN)

You're late, the session starts in 6 minutes, or you've only got 40 minutes total. This is your fallback, not your standard. If you cut, cut raise and mobility, never the specific build-up at the end. That's what protects you most.

NO.	EXERCISE	DOSE	WHY
01	Easy cardio	2 min, last 30 s quicker	Temperature and heart rate
02	World's greatest stretch	2 / side	Hips, thoracic, hamstrings
03	Leg swings	8 + 8 / leg	Hips through range
04	Glute bridge + band pull-apart	10 + 10	Glutes and upper back on
05	Pogo jumps	15 s	Push-off
06	Specific build-up	1–2 light sets or 2 strides	Whatever comes next in the session

03 · BEFORE RUNNING

YOUR RUN STARTS BEFORE THE START.

Two runs a week are in your plan. Easy runs and intervals need different prep. Here's both.

Before a run you're mainly getting calves, Achilles, hips and coordination ready. Running drills aren't school PE. They teach you to run tall, push off the forefoot and keep your feet quick. That's exactly what you need in kilometre eight of a race, after wall balls, when your stride starts to shrink.

STEP 1 · EASY JOG (5–10 MIN)

Start slower than your lowest pace zone from the entry test. Seriously slow. The first few minutes should feel almost embarrassingly easy. Then ease into a relaxed pace. Running outside in winter? Add a layer and drop it after the drills.

STEP 2 · RUNNING DRILLS (4–5 MIN)

Over 20–30 m, jog or walk back. Each drill twice.

HIGH KNEES 2 × 20 M	Quick knees to hip height, short steps, tall torso. **Watch out:** don't lean back, land under you on the forefoot.
BUTT KICKS 2 × 20 M	Heels flick quickly to the glutes, knee points down. **Watch out:** speed, not force. Light feet.
A-SKIP 2 × 20 M	Skip with a high knee drive while the other foot actively paws down under the body. One-two rhythm. **Watch out:** arms work with the legs, elbows at 90°.
B-SKIP 2 × 20 M	Like an A-skip, but extend the lower leg out front and actively pull it back down under you. **Watch out:** the leg comes down by pulling with the hamstring, not by dropping.
CARIOCA 2 × 20 M / SIDE	Moving sideways, the trailing leg crosses alternately in front and behind. Hip rotation and coordination. **Watch out:** shoulders stay square, the hips do the turning.
LATERAL SHUFFLE 2 × 15 M / SIDE	Low athletic stance, quick side steps. Preps the outside of the hip. **Watch out:** feet don't click together, toes point forward.

STEP 3 · STRIDES

STRIDES
3–6 × 80–100 M

Build up smoothly, hold the middle section quick (roughly 5 km pace or faster), float the last 10–20 m. Walk or jog back. **Watch out:** fast but relaxed. No all-out sprint, no clenched jaw.

EASY RUN VS. INTERVALS

SESSION	RAISE	DRILLS	STRIDES	TOTAL
Easy / long run	First 5–10 min of the run extra slow	Optional, 1 round	0–2 at the end of the run	Warm-up is part of the run
Tempo / race pace	8–10 min jog	Full set, 2 rounds	3–4, last one at target pace	15–18 min
Intervals (200–1000 m)	10 min jog	Full set, 2 rounds	4–6, last two faster than interval pace	18–20 min
Treadmill in the gym	5–8 min, build gradually	Next to the treadmill, 1–2 rounds	3 × 20–30 s on the belt	12–15 min

No extra warm-up before an easy run. Just start slower and let your body settle in. Before intervals, warm up properly. The faster the reps, the more strides, and the faster the last ones. Then your first rep isn't a shock.

THE RULE

Your first rep should be as fast as your second. If the first one is always the worst, your warm-up is too short. Add one or two strides and another round of drills.

FROM PRACTICE

One client's first 1 km rep was consistently 8–10 seconds slower and harder than the rest. We changed nothing except adding 4 strides and 2 rounds of drills. Two weeks later, rep one was on pace. Same fitness, the body was just ready.

04 · BEFORE STRENGTH

HEAVY LOADS NEED A RAMP-UP.

Strength sessions need switched-on muscles and, above all, ramp-up sets. You never take your working weight cold.

After the universal warm-up, add short activation for the day's work. Squats and lunges want hips, ankles and trunk. Deadlifts and sled pulls want glutes, hamstrings and upper back. Overhead work and wall balls want thoracic spine and shoulders. Then ramp up.

ACTIVATION BY DAY (3–4 MIN)

LOWER BODY (SQUAT, LUNGES, DEADLIFT)

GLUTE BRIDGE 2 × 10 · 2 S HOLD	Go single-leg if double-leg is too easy. **Watch out:** pelvis stays level, no lower-back arch.
LATERAL BAND WALK 2 × 10 STEPS / SIDE	Band above the knees or at the ankles, quarter squat, step sideways. Wakes up glute med, which keeps the knee in line. **Watch out:** keep tension on the band the whole time.
GOBLET SQUAT WITH PAUSE 2 × 5 · 3 S AT BOTTOM	Light KB at the chest. At the bottom, elbows nudge the knees out. **Watch out:** heels down, chest up.

UPPER BODY (PRESSES, PULLS, SKIERG, WALL BALLS)

BAND PULL-APART 2 × 15	Variations: overhand, underhand, diagonal. **Watch out:** arms nearly straight, movement comes from the shoulder blades.
SCAP PUSH-UP 10 REPS	In a plank, arms straight, just squeeze and spread the shoulder blades. **Watch out:** no sagging hips, the movement is small.
OPEN BOOK 6 / SIDE	Lie on your side, knees bent, top arm opens the chest to the other side. Thoracic rotation. **Watch out:** knees stay stacked and on the floor.
SHOULDER PASS-THROUGH 10 REPS	Band or dowel with a wide grip, over the head and behind, then back. **Watch out:** if the elbows bend or the lower back arches, widen the grip.

RAMP-UP SETS

The heavier the working weight, the more steps. Percentages are of that day's working weight, not your max. Reps drop as you go so you don't tire yourself out.

STEP	HEAVY DAY (1–5 REPS)	MODERATE DAY (6–10 REPS)	LIGHT / VOLUME (12+ REPS)
01	Empty bar / light KB × 8–10	Empty bar × 8–10	Empty bar × 10
02	40% × 5	50% × 6	60% × 6–8
03	60% × 3	70% × 4	Working sets
04	75% × 2	85% × 2	
05	85–90% × 1	Working sets	
06	Working sets		

Example: today is back squat 5 × 5 at 80 kg. Ramp-up: 20 kg bar × 10, 35 kg × 5, 50 kg × 3, 60 kg × 2, 70 kg × 1, then working sets. Rest 60–90 s in the ramp-up, longer before the first working set.

- **Always ramp up on the first lift of the day.** For later lifts hitting the same area, 1–2 sets are enough.
- **Every ramp-up set is a technique set.** Same depth, speed and setup as the working sets. If it looks bad now, it'll look worse under load.
- **The ramp-up is a diagnostic.** If 70% feels unusually heavy, drop your working weight by 5–10%. Days vary, the plan can take it.

THE RULE

Your working weight is never the first heavy thing you lift that day. There are always at least two steps before it. You avoid injury and your working sets get stronger.

CAUTION

Sharp pain, a sudden twinge, or pain that gets worse as you ramp up means stop. Don't push through it. Adjust the exercise or the load and post in the WhatsApp group. If it keeps coming back, see a physio or doctor.

05 · BEFORE HYROX SESSIONS

STATIONS NEED THEIR OWN PREP.

HYROX sessions mix running, strength and stations under fatigue. So your warm-up has to touch every station on the menu, plus at least one transition from running into a station.

The flow: universal warm-up (chapter 02), then the specific part. Hit each station in the session with 1–2 short, light sets. The goal isn't fatigue. You're reminding yourself of the technique, setting up the machine, finding your grip and getting the rhythm into your body. Sled, wall balls and running on the plan? Warm up sled, wall balls and running. Nothing more.

STATION-SPECIFIC BUILD-UP

SKIERG 2 × 30 S · BUILD	First 15 s arms and lats only, then add the hip hinge and a slight knee bend. Second set at session pace. **Watch out:** the pull starts from the lats and trunk, not by bending the elbows. Set the damper you plan to use.
ROW 2 × 30 S · BUILD	Build the stroke: arms only, then arms and body, then full stroke. Then 30 s at session pace. **Watch out:** legs-body-arms on the drive, arms-body-legs on the way back. The legs do most of the work.
SLED PUSH 2 × 10-12.5 M	First length empty or half load, second closer to working weight. Low position, arms straight or bent, short fast steps. **Watch out:** drive through the whole foot, hips don't pop up.
SLED PULL 2 × ONE ROPE LENGTH	Lighter load. Find your stance, a steady hand-over-hand rhythm and use your legs as you step back. **Watch out:** keep the rope from tangling under your feet. Pull with legs and back, not just arms.
BURPEE BROAD JUMP 3-5 REPS	Slow and clean. Chest to the floor, feet parallel on take-off and landing, just like on race day. Find a rhythm you can hold for 80 m. **Watch out:** don't test your longest jump. The longest jump is the most expensive one.
WALKING LUNGES 10-16 STEPS	Bodyweight or a light sandbag. Back knee gently touches the floor, torso tall. **Watch out:** no shuffle steps between reps. Treat it as practice for the race standard.

WALL BALLS
2 × 8-10

First set squat to target with no ball or a lighter one, second with your working ball. Find your distance from the wall and your breathing. **Watch out:** full-depth squat, the ball flies off your legs, arms just guide it.

FARMERS CARRY
1 × 20-30 M

Lighter kettlebells or dumbbells. Shoulders down, short quick steps. **Watch out:** grip deep in the palm, no swaying side to side.

TRANSITIONS

In a HYROX race you go from run to station 8 times and station to run 8 times. The Roxzone is where people give away time for free. If the session has both running and stations, finish your warm-up with one mini transition:

01 200 m easy jog.

02 Straight onto a station: 30 s easy (SkiErg, row, wall balls or sled).

03 Straight back to running: 100–200 m. Notice how quickly your stride and breathing settle.

Once is enough. The point is that your first transition in the main set isn't the first one of the day. Your legs get used to that jelly feeling after a station, and your head knows what's coming.

EXAMPLE: HYROX SESSION WARM-UP

On the plan: 4 rounds of 1 km run + 20 wall balls + 50 m sled push. Warm-up:

TIME	WHAT	DETAIL
0–12 min	Universal STR2G warm-up	Chapter 02, all of it
12–15 min	Running drills + 2 strides	High knees, A-skip, butt kicks
15–18 min	Wall balls 2 × 8, sled push 2 × 10 m	Light, technique, setup
18–20 min	Mini transition	200 m jog → 10 wall balls → 100 m run
20–22 min	Drink, set up stations, go	Max 2–3 min break

COACH'S TIP

In a group HYROX class at Form Factory, the coach leads the warm-up. Arrive early and do your own raise and mobility, then you join already moving. Arrive late and don't jump straight into the main set. At least do the express version on the side.

06 · RACE DAY

WARM UP TO YOUR START TIME.

Nothing new on race day. You run the same sequence you've practised, just pinned to your wave start time.

HYROX races start in waves at regular intervals. According to the official 2025/26 rulebook, you must be at the start area (start tunnel) **10 minutes before your start time**. That's your fixed point. Everything else counts back from it. The rules also say there's a designated warm-up area with race-relevant equipment. Expect it to be packed though, and have a plan that works without it.

TIMELINE (T = YOUR WAVE START)

TIME	WHAT TO DO	DETAIL
BEFORE THE WARM-UP		
T −90 to −60	Checked in, bags stored, food done	Last smaller meal about 2–3 h before, small snack by T −60. Details in the Complete Nutrition Guide PDF.
T −60 to −45	Change, toilet, walk the course	Find the start, the Roxzone and the route from the warm-up area to the start. Check whether waves are on time.
WARM-UP		
T −45 to −35	Raise	8–10 min jog or bike / row / SkiErg, easy. Hoodie or jacket on.
T −35 to −27	Mobilise + activate	Blocks 2 and 3 of the universal warm-up, in full.
T −27 to −20	Running drills + strides	1 round of drills, 3–4 strides, last two at your 1 km race pace. Not faster.
T −20 to −14	Specific build-up	Whatever the area offers: SkiErg 2 × 20 s, 5 wall balls, 2 burpee broad jumps, 6 lunges. Easy.
HEADING TO THE START		
T −14 to −10	Drink, toilet, layers on	A few sips, not a litre. Final check of chip, laces and bib.
T −10	In the start area	Mandatory per the rulebook. Briefing, checks, waiting.

TIME	WHAT TO DO	DETAIL
T –10 to –1	Stay warm	Mini primer every 2–3 min (see below). Calm breathing, first kilometre plan in your head.
T –1	Top layer off	Last 2–3 pogos or quick high knees on the spot. Go.

Check-in times and how the warm-up area runs vary by event. Always read the athlete information for your race and build in a buffer. Doubles and relay teams warm up together so everyone is ready at the same moment.

HOW TO STAY WARM IN THE START CORRIDOR

Ten minutes standing in a hall is enough to lose much of your warm-up. So:

- **Layers.** An old hoodie or throwaway top you don't mind ditching. Find out beforehand how the event handles discarded clothing.
- **Mini primer every 2–3 minutes:** 10 s high knees on the spot, 5 leg swings per leg, 10 pogos, 3 long exhales.
- **Don't sit down.** Stand, shift, keep moving in a small space.
- **Breathe, don't panic.** 4 s in through the nose, 6 s out. A few cycles take the edge off a nervous heart rate.
- **If the start is delayed 10+ minutes,** do a short block again: 1 min jog or march on the spot, a round of leg swings, 2 × 10 s fast feet.

NO ROOM TO RUN

At some events, there's simply no space to run in a packed warm-up area. Then:

THERE'S A MACHINE

- Raise: 8 min bike / row / SkiErg, last 2 min quicker
- Mobility and activation as normal
- Instead of strides: 3 × 15 s fast on the machine + 3 × 10 s high knees on the spot

NOTHING BUT 2 × 2 M OF FLOOR

- Raise: 4 min marching and jogging on the spot, jumping jacks, skipping on the spot
- Mobility and activation as normal
- Instead of strides: 4 × 10 s fast high knees + 2 × 5 pogos, 30 s easy between

THE RULE

Race day is not the day to try anything you haven't done in training. No new stretch, no new drill, no new band borrowed from a mate. The warm-up you did in weeks 7–11 is exactly the one you do at the race.

07 · COOL-DOWN

TEN MINUTES THAT PAY YOU BACK.

A cool-down won't magically speed up recovery. But it helps your body and head settle, lets you check what hurts, and means you leave the gym calm, not at 150 bpm.

After a hard session your body is still in full work mode. Slowing down gradually brings heart rate and breathing down, shifts you from performance mode to rest, and gives you a moment to think about how the session went. It's also the right time for static stretching, which doesn't belong before training. It doesn't have to be long. 5–10 minutes does the job.

BASIC COOL-DOWN (5–10 MIN)

01 **Slow down (3–5 min).** Walk, easy jog, bike or row at a pace you could sing to. Heart rate down, breathing calm.

02 **Breathe (1–2 min).** 90/90 breathing on your back, feet up on a bench or box. In through the nose, long exhale through the mouth.

03 **Static stretching (3–5 min).** 2–3 stretches matched to the session. 30–60 s per side, relaxed and pain-free.

COOL-DOWN EXERCISES

90/90 BREATHING
6–10 BREATHS

On your back, calves on a bench, knees and hips at 90°. Breathe in through the nose for 4 s into belly and sides, out through the mouth for 6–8 s. **Watch out:** relaxed shoulders and neck, don't breathe into the chest.

COUCH STRETCH
45–60 S / SIDE

Back knee against a wall or bench, foot up behind you, front foot forward in a lunge. Stretches quads and hip flexors, which take a beating from running, lunges and wall balls. **Watch out:** tuck the pelvis and squeeze the back glute. If you feel it in your lower back, ease off.

HAMSTRING STRETCH
45 S / SIDE

On your back, band around the foot, straight leg up. **Watch out:** other leg stays on the floor, lower back stays down.

WALL CALF STRETCH
45 S / SIDE

Hands on the wall, back leg straight, heel down. Then bend the knee to hit the lower calf. **Watch out:** foot points straight ahead.

PIGEON
45–60 S / SIDE

Front leg bent across in front of you, back leg long, slowly lower the torso. Glutes and hip rotators. **Watch out:** if the front knee complains, bring the heel closer to your body.

CHILD'S POSE WITH REACH
5–8 BREATHS

Kneel, hips to heels, arms reaching far forward. Back, lats and shoulders after SkiErg and sled pull. **Watch out:** breathe into your back, let the shoulders drop.

BY SESSION TYPE

AFTER	SLOW DOWN	STRETCH	ALSO
Intervals / tempo	5–8 min easy jog or walk	Calves, couch stretch, hamstrings	Drink, refuel with carbs and protein
Strength	3–5 min very easy bike or row	Matched to the lifts: pigeon, couch stretch, child's pose	90/90 breathing 1–2 min
HYROX / simulation	5 min walk, then easy bike	Couch stretch, calves, child's pose	Log station and transition splits in the app
Easy run	Last 2–3 min slower	Optional calves and hamstrings	Nothing else needed
Race	10–15 min walking, not sitting	Later that evening or the next day, gently	Fluids, food within 1 h, light movement next day

AFTER THE RACE

Walk first. Don't sit on the floor at the finish and stay there for 20 minutes. Ten minutes of walking, fluids, something to eat. Leave deep stretching for later. Your muscles are tired and damaged after a race, and aggressive stretching won't help them. Next day, light movement: walk, bike, swim. The Mobility & Recovery and Race Day + Checklists PDFs cover this in detail.

THE RULE

The cool-down is also your check-in. What hurts? What felt tight? Where did your technique fall apart? Two sentences in the notes in the training app tell you and us coaches more than a week of guessing.

08 · EXERCISE LIBRARY

EVERY EXERCISE IN ONE PLACE.

How to do every exercise in this guide, plus the most common mistake. Grouped by RAMP step. Station technique videos are in the education library in the app.

RAISE

EASY JOG / MACHINE 3–10 MIN	Jog below your lowest pace zone, short stride, land under your body. Or bike, row, SkiErg at low resistance. **Mistake:** the warm-up slowly turns into a tempo session.
JUMPING JACKS 30 S	Feet out and in, arms overhead, light on the balls of the feet. **Mistake:** heavy heel landings and locked knees.

MOBILISE

WORLD'S GREATEST STRETCH 2–3 / SIDE	Deep lunge, hand down inside the front foot, elbow to ankle, then rotate and reach up, finish by straightening the front leg. **Mistake:** back knee drops to the floor and the rotation comes from the lower back.
LEG SWINGS 8–10 / DIRECTION / LEG	Front-back and side to side, holding a wall. Build range gradually, stay loose. **Mistake:** kicking hard and swinging the torso.
WALL ANKLE MOBS 8 / SIDE	Toes 5–10 cm from the wall, knee touches the wall, heel stays down. Move further back over time. **Mistake:** heel lifts and knee caves in.
INCHWORM 5 REPS	Fold forward, walk the hands out to a plank, walk the feet back in with small steps. **Mistake:** sagging lower back in the plank.
OPEN BOOK 6 / SIDE	Side-lying, knees at 90°, top arm sweeps an arc and opens the chest. Exhale at end range. **Mistake:** knees separate and the rotation comes from the pelvis.
SHOULDER PASS-THROUGH 10 REPS	Band or dowel, wide grip, smooth pass over the head behind you and back. **Mistake:** grip too narrow, bent elbows, arched lower back.

ACTIVATE

GLUTE BRIDGE 10 REPS · 2 S HOLD	On your back, feet close to the glutes, drive through the heels, hips up to a line from knees to shoulders. **Mistake:** arching the lower back instead of squeezing the glutes.
DEAD BUG 6 / SIDE	On your back, arms to the ceiling, legs at 90/90. Slowly extend opposite arm and leg, lower back stays in contact with the floor. **Mistake:** rushing and letting the back lift.
BAND PULL-APART 15 REPS	Band at arm's length in front, pull apart to the chest, shoulder blades back and down. **Mistake:** shrugging and bending the elbows.
LATERAL BAND WALK 10 STEPS / SIDE	Band above the knees, quarter squat, short side steps, band always under tension. **Mistake:** knees cave in, torso rocks side to side.
SCAP PUSH-UP 10 REPS	Plank, arms locked, only the shoulder blades squeeze together and spread apart. **Mistake:** bending the elbows instead of moving the shoulder blades.
GOBLET SQUAT WITH PAUSE 5 REPS · 3 S AT BOTTOM	Light KB at the chest, squat to depth, elbows gently push the knees out. **Mistake:** heels lift, back rounds.

POTENTIATE AND RUNNING DRILLS

POGO JUMPS 2 × 15 S	Fast, low hops from the ankles, minimal knee bend. **Mistake:** big jumps with long ground contact.
SQUAT JUMP / BROAD JUMP 2 × 3	Jump up or forward from a quarter squat with an arm swing, soft landing. **Mistake:** knees caving on landing.
HIGH KNEES 2 × 20 M	Quick knees to hip height, short steps, tall torso. **Mistake:** leaning back and landing on the heels.
BUTT KICKS 2 × 20 M	Heels to glutes, knee points to the floor, high cadence. **Mistake:** knees drift forward and the stride gets long.
A-SKIP 2 × 20 M	Rhythmic skip with a knee drive, stance foot actively strikes under the body. **Mistake:** passive arms and sitting in the hips.
B-SKIP 2 × 20 M	From the A-skip, extend the lower leg and actively pull the foot back down under you. **Mistake:** foot lands in front of the body instead of under it.

CARIOCA 2 × 20 M / SIDE	Moving sideways, trailing leg crosses alternately in front and behind, hips rotate. **Mistake:** shoulders rotate too and the whole thing slows down.
LATERAL SHUFFLE 2 × 15 M / SIDE	Low athletic stance, quick side steps. **Mistake:** bouncing up instead of moving sideways.
STRIDES 3-6 × 80-100 M	Smooth acceleration to a quick pace, stay relaxed, float out. Walk back. **Mistake:** all-out sprint and a tense body.

HYROX STATIONS (LIGHT BUILD-UP)

SKIERG 2 × 20-30 S	Hands high, pull from the lats and trunk, hips go back, slight knee bend. **Mistake:** pulling with the arms only and squatting deep.
ROW 2 × 30 S	Drive: legs, body, arms. Recovery: arms, body, legs. Feet strapped in tight. **Mistake:** bent arms at the catch.
SLED PUSH 2 × 10-12.5 M	Low position, torso angled, quick short steps through the whole foot. **Mistake:** hips high and long strides.
SLED PULL 1-2 ROPE LENGTHS	Solid stance, hand over hand, step back and pull with the legs. **Mistake:** standing still and pulling with the biceps only.
BURPEE BROAD JUMP 3-5 REPS	Chest to the floor, feet parallel on take-off and landing, moderate jump length. **Mistake:** max-length jumps that cook your legs.
WALKING LUNGES 10-16 STEPS	Back knee touches the floor, torso tall, no shuffle steps. **Mistake:** steps too short and the knee caving in.
WALL BALLS 2 × 8-10	Full-depth squat, drive the ball off your legs, catch straight into the next squat. **Mistake:** shallow squat and throwing with the arms.
FARMERS CARRY 20-30 M	Shoulders down, trunk braced, short quick steps. **Mistake:** fingertip grip and swaying side to side.

09 · CHEAT SHEET

PRINT IT. STICK IT UP.

SESSION TYPE	SEQUENCE	TIME
BEFORE TRAINING		
Easy / long run	First 5–10 min extra slow → optional drills → 0–2 strides	in the run
Tempo / race pace	8–10 min jog → drills × 2 → 3–4 strides, last at target pace	15–18 min
Intervals	10 min jog → drills × 2 → 4–6 strides, last two above interval pace	18–20 min
Strength	Universal (02) → activation for the day (04) → 3–5 ramp-up sets	15–20 min
HYROX session	Universal (02) → 2 strides → 1–2 sets per station → mini transition	18–22 min
Express	2 min cardio → WGS → swings → bridge + pull-apart → pogos → 1–2 sets	5–6 min
RACE (T = WAVE START)		
T –45 to –35	Raise: jog or machine, layers on	10 min
T –35 to –20	Mobilise + activate → drills → 3–4 strides at race pace	15 min
T –20 to –14	Easy stations: SkiErg, 5 wall balls, 2 BBJs, 6 lunges	6 min
T –10 to 0	In the start area. Mini primer every 2–3 min, 4/6 breathing	10 min
AFTER TRAINING		
Cool-down	3–5 min easy → 90/90 breathing → 2–3 stretches, 30–60 s	5–10 min

UNIVERSAL STR2G WARM-UP (02)

- [ ] Raise · 3–4 min cardio + 30 s jumping jacks
- [ ] Mobilise · WGS 3/side · leg swings 10+10 · wall ankle mobs 8/side · inchworm 5
- [ ] Activate · glute bridge 10 · dead bug 6/side · band pull-apart 15
- [ ] Potentiate · pogos 2 × 15 s · squat jump / broad jump 2 × 3

MY WAVE START

STR2G HYROX

PLAN. TRAIN. PERFORM.

Got a question? Drop it in the WhatsApp group. We, your coaches, answer.

STRONGER TOGETHER.